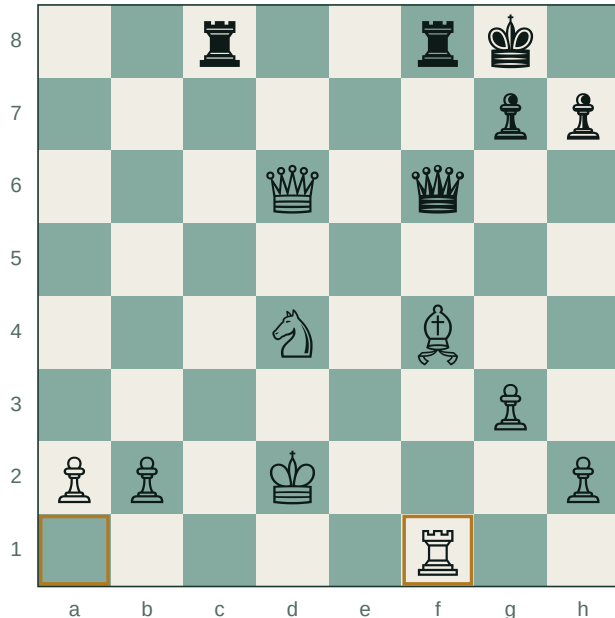


Pins and pressure: Black, move 24

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 24.Rxf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24...Qxd6 25. Bxd6 Rxf1

24...Qxd6 The queen captures the queen on d6. From d6 it attacks knight on d4 and bishop on f4. Recorded reply: **25.Bxd6**.

25...Rxf1 The rook captures the rook on f1.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on d2. Geometrically undefended: rook on f1. Check for tactical protection.